

Alan Kydd

Senior Software Engineer

Summary

Senior Software Engineer with 18 years of experience designing and building backend systems and scalable web applications in startups and large organizations. Specialized in Go, APIs, and cloud-based infrastructure, with strong experience building scalable services and internal tools that improve operational efficiency. Recent work includes leading backend development for major features in a SaaS platform, integrating Google Workspace and AWS infrastructure, and developing internal systems enabling non-engineers to manage complex workflows.

Key Skills

Languages: Go, TypeScript, Clojure, SQL

Backend: Go, GraphQL, REST APIs, microservices, Clojure

Frontend: React, Redux, TypeScript, ClojureScript

Tools: Claude Code, Git, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, CircleCI

Infrastructure: AWS (S3, CloudFront, ACM, ECS Fargate, RDS, ALB), Terraform, Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, Apache Kafka

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Cassandra

Other: Stripe, Adyen, Google Workspace

Experience

Senior Fullstack Engineer, *Looka*, Toronto, Ontario.

10/2022–09/2025

Laid off due to company-wide reduction in force.

- Led backend architecture and implementation (Go, GraphQL) for two major customer-facing features in Looka's flagship SaaS platform:
 - Google Workspace Reseller integration allowing customers to purchase and manage subscriptions directly within Looka.
 - AWS-based website hosting platform enabling users to deploy branded websites, built on S3, CloudFront, and Amazon Certificate Manager.
- Managed Kubernetes cluster operations: container configuration, Helm chart deployments, node lifecycle management, and secrets management.
- Implemented a drop-shadow feature for Looka's SVG-based graphic editor.
- Developed TypeScript automation tools for the Customer Service team, reducing engineering involvement in support cases and improving ticket resolution speed.
- Maintained CI/CD pipelines (CircleCI) for automated testing.

Senior Software Engineer, *Betable*, Edmonton, Alberta.

09/2021–10/2022

- Designed and delivered a React/Redux application with supporting backend REST endpoints (Go) for managing third-party online casino games.
- Replaced a manual engineering workflow with an internal tool that enabled non-engineers to manage game deployments independently.
- Contributed to an Adyen payment integration, implementing a Go microservice backend with Angular and React frontends.

Software Engineer, *Betable*, Edmonton, Alberta.

01/2016–09/2021

- Developed internal marketing tools enabling non-technical teams to create, edit, and schedule promotions, bonuses, and game offers.
- Implemented backend services and features (including Go-based components) alongside React/Redux front-end development.

Developer, *Gamesys Canada*, Edmonton, Alberta.

08/2013–10/2015

Laid off due to company restructuring.

- Built a Backbone.js single-page application for managing online poker tournaments, communicating with an event-driven microservice backend using Apache Kafka.
- Contributed to a GWT analytics application used to investigate poker game fraud and analyze player win/loss data.

Selected Systems & Backend Projects

Anomaly Detector: <https://github.com/akydd/log-anomale-detector>. Built a cloud-based log anomaly detection system using Go and AWS, processing application logs to identify unusual patterns and surface potential issues. Designed as a distributed pipeline, with infrastructure provisioned via Terraform and services deployed on AWS. Emphasizes observability, scalability, and real-world monitoring use cases.

RealWorld Go API: <https://github.com/akydd/realworld-backend-go>. RealWorld backend API in Go using hexagonal architecture, deployed to AWS ECS Fargate with Terraform. CI/CD via GitHub Actions with OIDC-based AWS authentication, integration tests using Hurl, and secrets management via AWS Secrets Manager.

RealWorld Clojure API: <https://github.com/akydd/realworld-clojure>. Implemented the RealWorld backend API in Clojure, applying functional design principles and idiomatic patterns to build a production-style REST API. Demonstrates backend architecture, authentication flows, and practical use of Clojure in real-world service development.

Education

Master of Science, *University of Alberta*, Edmonton.

Pure Mathematics

Bachelor of Science, *University of Alberta*, Edmonton.

Mathematics Specialization